CS 377
Heinz dilemma text via Eric Kim
Porcupine text via Mikhail Lyubansky

Care Ethics: Group Reflection

Group members:

Section (circle one)	12:30pm	2:00pm

Work through these questions together as a group. Turn in one sheet per group at the end of class.

The Heinz Dilemma

A lady was dying because she was very sick. There was one drug the doctors said might save her. This medicine was discovered by a man living in that same town. It cost him $400 to make it, but he charged $4000 for just a little bit of it. The sick lady's husband, Heinz, tried to borrow enough money to buy the drug. He went to everyone he knew to borrow the money. But he could only borrow half of what he needed. He told the man who made the drug that his wife was dying, and asked him to sell the medicine cheaper or let him pay him later. But the man said "No, I made the drug and I am going to make money from it." So Heinz broke into the store and stole the drug.

Should Heinz have stolen the drug? Why or why not?

The Porcupine and the Moles

As the winter grew cold, a porcupine was looking for a home and found a most desirable cave. The cave was occupied by a family of moles.

"Would you mind if I shared your home for the winter?" the porcupine asked the moles.

The generous moles consented and the porcupine moved in. But the cave was small and every time the moles moved around they were scratched by the porcupine's sharp quills. The moles endured this discomfort for as long as they could. Then at last they gathered courage to approach their visitor.

"Pray leave," they said, "and let us have our cave to ourselves once again."

"Oh no!" said the porcupine. "This place suits me very well. If you're not happy, then *you* should leave!"

What should be done?